

# FreeLLMAPI setup guide

One API key → the free tiers of 34 AI providers. Works with Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Cline and any OpenAI-compatible app.

● [github.com/tashfeenahmed/freellmapi](https://github.com/tashfeenahmed/freellmapi) · MIT · v0.13.0

## First, the truth (my own test)

**40**

free models, zero keys

**0**

answers from real Claude

**2**

different models for the same question

- **You do NOT get Claude or GPT.** I set Claude Code to `--model sonnet` and asked the same question twice. FreeLLMAPI's own log: `poolside/laguna-s-2.1:free`, then `dots-3-note-preview:free`.
- The tool is honest about it: the README says "**no frontier models**", and Keys → Anthropic maps Opus / Sonnet / Haiku → `auto` (a free model).
- "7.4 billion tokens a month" = every provider's free quota **added together**, not what one user gets. Models get weaker late in the day as caps run out.

### Privacy:

some free providers log prompts for training (the no-key Kilo gateway, per FreeLLMAPI's own source). Never paste company code, passwords or client data.

# 1. Install (pick one)

**Windows / Mac, easiest:** the desktop app from [Releases](#) (.exe / .dmg), runs in your tray.

**Docker** (Mac / Linux / WSL):

```
curl -fsSL https://freellmapi.co/install.sh | bash
```

**npm** (Node 20+), with `HOST` so it stays on your own PC:

```
git clone https://github.com/tashfeenahmed/freellmapi.git
cd freellmapi
npm install
$k = node -e
"console.log(require('crypto').randomBytes(32).toString('hex'))"
"ENCRYPTION_KEY=$k`nPORT=3001`nHOST=127.0.0.1" | Out-File -Encoding ascii
.env
npm run dev
```

Without

`HOST=127.0.0.1`

the npm version listens on all network interfaces. Docker already binds to 127.0.0.1.

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## 2. Turn on the no-key providers

Keys → Add key → search "**no key**" → enable **Kilo Gateway**, **OVH AI Endpoints**, **AI Horde**. That alone gave me 40 free models.

For better models add free keys (no card) from Google AI Studio, Groq, Cerebras, OpenRouter. Read each free tier's terms: several use free-tier data to improve their models.

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### 3. Copy your one API key

Keys page header → the **unified API key** (starts with `freellmapi-`). Base URL for OpenAI-style apps: `http://localhost:3001/v1`

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### 4. Connect Claude Code

PowerShell:

```
$env:ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL = "http://localhost:3001"  
$env:ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN = "freellmapi-your-key"  
claude
```

Mac / Linux:

```
export ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL=http://localhost:3001  
export ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN=freellmapi-your-key  
claude
```

Use `ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN`, not `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`. Or: `npx freellmapi setup-claude --url http://localhost:3001 --api-key <key>`

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### 5. Check which model REALLY answered

Dashboard → **Analytics** → **Recent calls**: *Client app* `claude-cli/...` = Claude Code, *Model* = the real model. API users: the `x-routed-via` response header.

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# Safety checklist

- ☐ Running on 127.0.0.1 only (not your Wi-Fi)
- ☐ No company code / passwords / client data in prompts
- ☐ Free-tier terms read for every provider you add
- ☐ Paid API for anything real

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